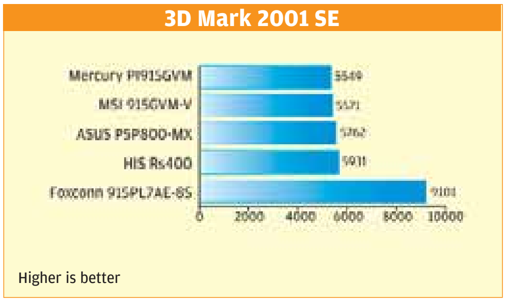
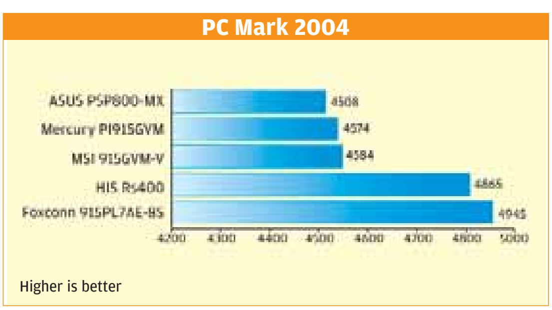



The 21-point difference is almost negligible, and these boards should be considered on par for all practical purposes.

The Foxconn 915PL7AE-8S scored a massive 9101 3DMarks, but since it was tested with a graphics card, it is completely unfair to compare this board to the boards tested with their onboard video solutions.

In our overall system benchmark, PCMark 2004, everything went topsy-turvy. The MSI 915GVM-V logged the highest CPU index at 5492, edging out the Foxconn 915, which came in second at 5481. The third spot was taken up by the Mercury PI915GVM, which logged a close 5477—which was not all that surprising, since all these boards were LGA 775-based and had the same CPU.

The overall scores of this benchmark reflected the true overall system performance and here, the Foxconn 915PL7AE-8S lead by a hairsbreadth over the

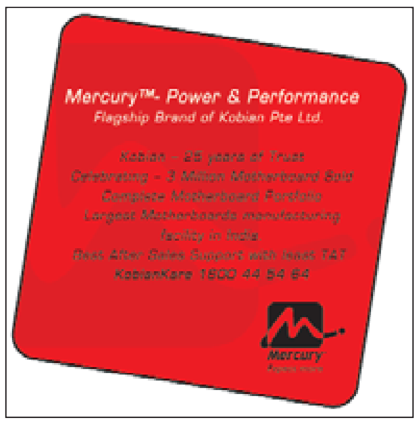



HIS RS400 which clocked 4865, which is extremely good considering the fact that the scores of the Foxconn were bumped up by the external graphics card.

In SiSoft Sandra, our second synthetic benchmark for system performance, the LGA 775 socket processors had an advantage over the older socket 478 processors in the CPU subsystem tests but as was the case in AMD boards, this advantage should be noted and included while evaluation as 775 is the de facto Intel socket, and 478 has been phased out.

In the memory subsystem, the AOpen emerged the winner, scoring 4670 in the ALU/RAM and 4659 in FPU/RAM tests. This was a slightly higher than the second-placed Gigabyte GA8I915GV-MF, which scored 4641 and 4638. The Foxconn board managed just 4524 and 4537, and thus lost out here. The worst scores came from the HIS FA-61, which could manage just 2571 and 2570 respectively.

The CPU sub-system scores were quite varied and produced various winners. The Dhrystone test was won by the MSI PM8M2-V, which scored 10466 and



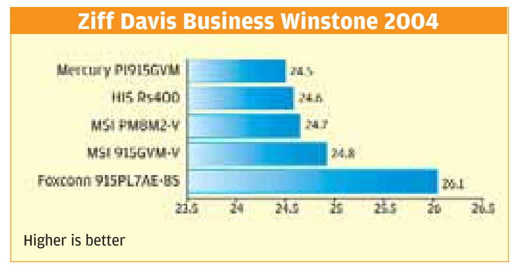

marginally beat the Mercury PI915GVM, which scored 10464. The difference is meaningless, really—both boards get a joint first here!

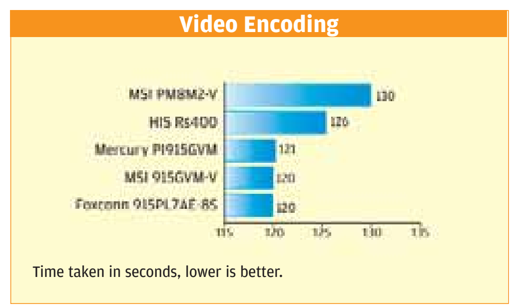
The Whetstone test was won by the MSI PM8M2-V with a score of 4318, which was just about better than the 4309 scored by the Asus P5P800-MX, which is an 865GV-based board and is not on PCIe—hence the performance is quite commendable.

The multimedia CPU test was won by the HIS RS400 with a score of 25437, and the FPU test was won by the MSI RS350M-ILSR with a score of 34651.

In the disk index tests, only three boards scored 51—these were the MSI RS350M-ILSR, Gigabyte GA-8IG1000 and GA-8I915GV. All the other boards ranged from 37 (for the HIS M48-F3) to 47. Hence the HIS M48-F3 is the last placed board here.

In our Business Winstone Benchmark, the clear winner once again was the Foxconn 915P7AE-8S with a score of 26.1. It quite comfortably beat the second-placed Asus P5P800-MX,

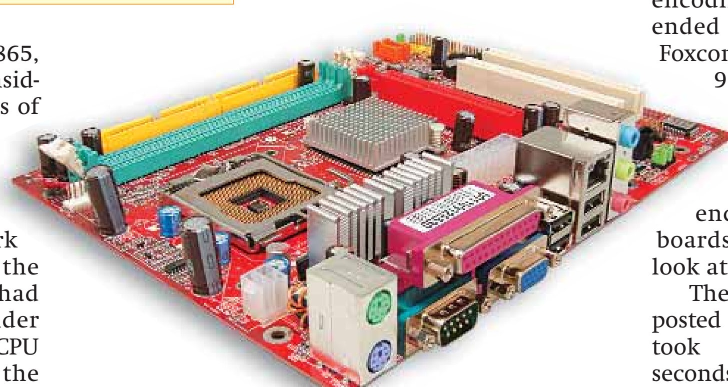



which scored 25. With a low 16, the loser here was the HIS M48-F3. The board was severely hampered by its older socket and chipset.

The final real world test we undertook was the video encoding file test. The test ended in a tie between the Foxconn 915 board and the MSI 915GVM-V, both taking just 120 seconds to encode our test file. If you plan to indulge in any amount of video encoding, these are the boards you definitely need to look at!

The worst times here were posted by the HIS M48-F3, which took a mind-boggling 201 seconds to do the same job! The board was, again, limited by its chipset and the socket.



MSI PM8M2-V